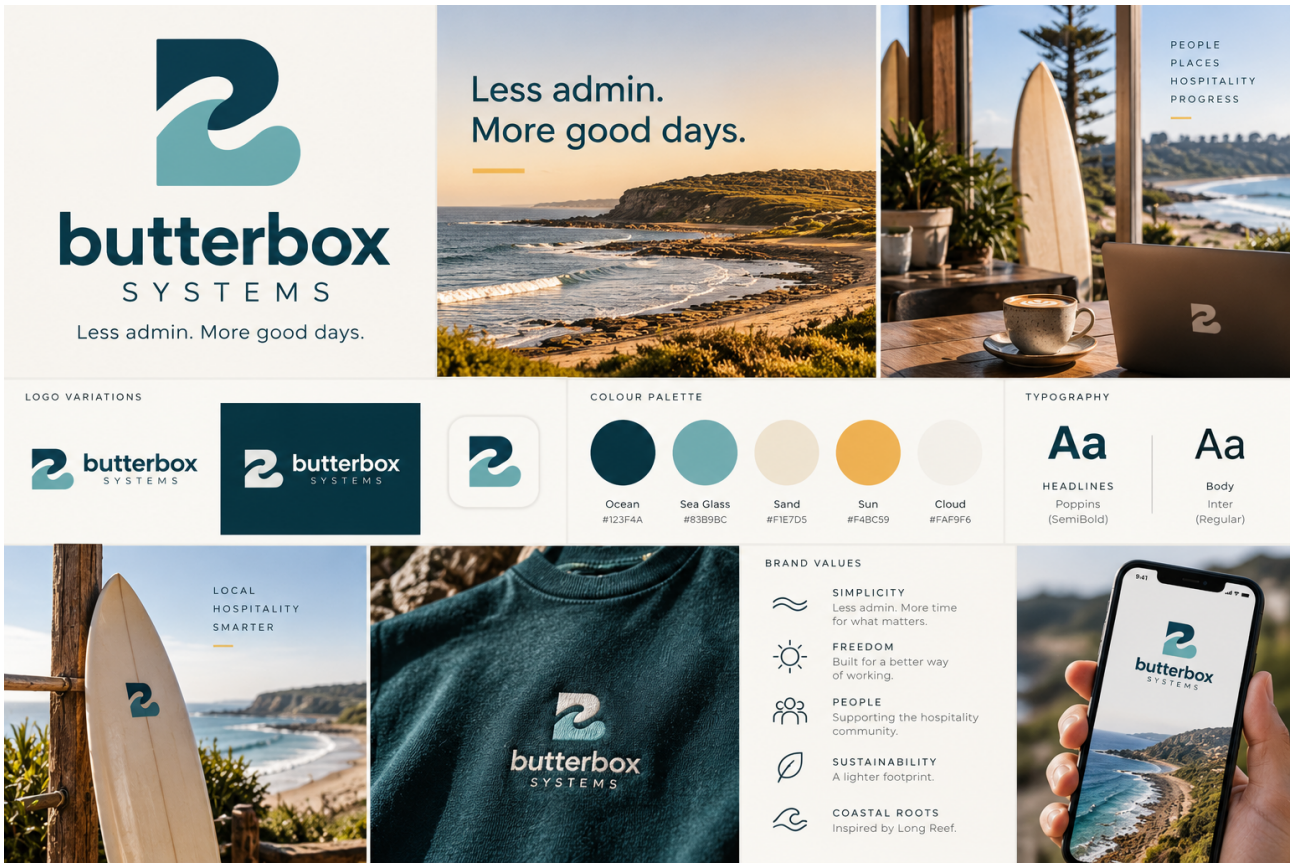
BUTTERBOX / SYSTEMS

A little less admin. A lot more good days.

BRAND IDENTITY & GUIDELINES — V1.0 | OCTOBER 2026

An Australian hospitality software brand born from the rhythm of cafés, surf and small businesses on Sydney's Northern Beaches.



Design status: The moodboard above is concept artwork. Logo shapes, photography and visual mockups are creative direction, not registered trademarks or cleared, production-ready master assets. Commission or trace an original vector master before launch.

01 The brand

Brand architecture

Primary customer-facing name: Butterbox. Formal descriptor: Butterbox Systems. The name Butterbox should lead in the application, product marketing, icon and domain experience; “Systems” clarifies the business context on proposals, invoices and formal communications.

Brand relationship: Butterbox Systems is a software venture inspired by Butterbox Café at Long Reef. Do not suggest ownership, endorsement or a formal commercial affiliation with the café unless agreed and documented.

Our purpose

Give small hospitality teams the freedom to focus on great service and good people instead of juggling rosters, group chats and timesheets.

Our promise

Smart, simple workforce tools that make busy hospitality days easier and more predictable—at a fair, transparent price.

Positioning

For independent cafés and restaurants with flexible teams, Butterbox is approachable workforce software that brings rostering, time capture, open shifts and payroll-ready time into one easy place—without enterprise complexity or per-employee price anxiety.

Personality

- Easygoing, not careless: relaxed style with dependable operational performance.
- Human, not corporate: speak like an experienced venue manager.
- Fresh, not frivolous: coastal energy without resort clichés.
- Practical, not flashy: show useful outcomes before technical features.

Tagline hierarchy

Primary: Less admin. More good days.

Product description: Rosters, timesheets and teams. Sorted.

Supporting line: Made for people who run hospitality.

02 Visual identity

Logo concept

A bespoke lowercase butterbox wordmark paired with a stylised B made from two flowing coastal wave forms. The mark should evoke movement, ease and the Long Reef coastline without resembling a generic palm tree or surf-school emblem.

Approved lockups to create

- Primary horizontal: wave-B symbol + butterbox, with SYSTEMS as an optional small descriptor.
- Stacked: wave-B above lowercase butterbox; useful for signage and presentations.
- Icon: standalone wave-B for favicon, app icon and social avatar.
- Monochrome: single-color navy or reversed white for constrained contexts.

Clearspace and sizing

Maintain clearspace around the logo equal to at least the height of the lowercase “b” bowl. Minimum digital wordmark width: 120 px. Minimum app icon: 32 × 32 px; provide simplified forms for 16–24 px contexts. These are draft specifications to validate once the final vector artwork is produced.

Do not

- Stretch, rotate, skew, add bevels or apply drop shadows to the logo.
- Put the sea-glass mark on backgrounds with insufficient contrast.
- Use stock imagery as part of the core logo or use an unlicensed café photograph.
- Lock “Systems” at the same visual prominence as “butterbox” on consumer app screens.

Brand colors

Color	Hex	Role
Ocean navy	#123F4A	Primary wordmark, navigation, headings
Sea glass	#83B9BC	Secondary brand surfaces and illustrations
Warm sand	#F1E7D5	Warm supporting background
Sun yellow	#F4BC59	Accent, highlights, selected action moments
Cloud	#FAF9F6	Primary light background

Use navy for the majority of interface text. Yellow is an accent, not the default small-text color. Verify WCAG contrast for every text/background combination.

03 Typography, imagery & voice

Typography

Headlines: Poppins SemiBold (or licensed/open-source equivalent). UI and body: Inter Regular/Medium. Use a restrained type scale, consistent spacing and sentence-case interface labels. Reserve letter-spaced capitals for small descriptors such as SYSTEMS.

Photography art direction

- Real Northern Beaches coastal environments: Long Reef headland, surf and coastal vegetation.
- Cafés in action: opening shifts, espresso machines, team interactions, natural timber and daylight.
- People-first: honest working moments rather than overly polished corporate poses.
- Warm early or late sunlight; sea-glass and navy tones; subtle grain is acceptable.

Important: Use genuine Long Reef/Butterbox Café photography only with appropriate permission or licence. Do not imply generated scenes are verified photos of the actual venue.

Illustration and iconography

Use simple outline icons with rounded geometry and consistent stroke widths. Favor purposeful icons for calendar, clock, team, location and notifications. Avoid decorative beach symbols in dense operational screens.

Voice and tone

Write like a supportive, capable café manager: clear, warm, succinct and confident. Prefer “Your roster is ready” over “Roster dissemination completed.” Use direct, informative error states, especially for attendance and payroll.

Message examples

Context	On-brand copy
Marketing headline	Less admin. More good days.
Roster publication	Your team’s roster is live.
Open shift	Extra barista shift available this Saturday.
Clock-in exception	We couldn’t verify your location. Your time request is saved for manager review.
Payroll success	Approved timesheets are ready to export.

04 Product brand in practice

Owner dashboard

Prioritise today’s team, who is clocked in, open shifts and timesheets needing approval. Use ocean navy navigation, warm cloud surfaces, sea-glass components and restrained yellow for prompts that deserve attention.

FOH and BOH manager views

Use the same component system with distinct department labels—not different color-coded brands. The owner can see the combined roster; managers see their assigned departments. Keep all controls mobile-responsive.

Employee experience

Focus on three immediate actions: next shift, clock in/out and open shifts. Use plain-language status messages and touch-friendly buttons. Never let decorative styling obscure confirmation or errors.

Core interface components

• Buttons: navy primary, outlined secondary, accessible destructive/error states.

• Status: use text + icon, never color alone; distinguish draft, published, pending and approved.

• Cards: warm neutral backgrounds, gentle borders, generous whitespace.

• Data density: show simple summaries first; allow deeper detail for payroll review and audit trails.

Brand governance

Owner: Product/design lead. Masters: maintain original SVG logo, wordmark variants, icon assets, color tokens and font licences in GitHub under /brand. Versioning: approve changes through a design review and update this guide. Legal: check Australian trademark and business-name conflicts, domain availability and permission to use Butterbox as a commercial software name before launch.

Suggested digital design tokens

Use --bb-ocean: #123F4A, --bb-seaglass: #83B9BC, --bb-sand: #F1E7D5, --bb-sun: #F4BC59, --bb-cloud: #FAF9F6. Maintain separate semantic tokens for success, warning and error; do not substitute brand yellow for a functional warning color.

Launch checklist

• Finalise legally cleared naming, original vector identity and trademark searches.

• Obtain photography rights and produce original website/application image assets.

• Accessibility-test brand colors and UI states across desktop/mobile.

• Apply consistent naming to login, email, payroll exports and terms/privacy pages.

North star: The brand should feel like the calm, capable person who makes a chaotic Saturday shift run smoothly.